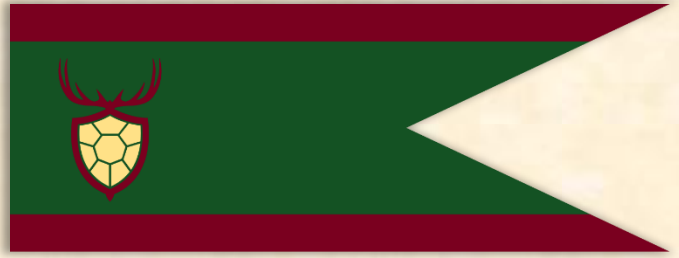


Tir Valaen



Theme/Vibe:

Ancient, mystical forest realm where impossible natural phenomena thrive. Vast and beautiful yet perilous, it embodies the neutrality of nature itself. The wondrous forests intertwine dangerous fey trickery.

Parallels/Inspiration:

- The forests of *The Legend of Zelda: Breath of the Wild* (Lost Woods)
- *Shadow of the Colossus* (grand, esoteric landscapes)
- *Princess Mononoke* (Studio Ghibli)

Government:

Confederacy. The **Rootbound Covenant** unites five semi-sovereign forest groves, each governing its own territory while pledging mutual support, open passage, and spiritual kinship. The sacred lake grove of **Thal'Anorim** serves as neutral ground where leaders convene on the ancient turtle-isle.

Description:

Tir Valaen ("Land of Many Roots") is a vast forestrealm sprawling across coastlines, canyons, and jungle-covered slopes. To the natives, the forest is identity, faith, and covenant. The canopy sings with spirit, and roots run deeper than bloodlines. The land itself is alive with breath and memory.

Across this green expanse lie the **Five Groves**, territories shaped by unique biomes, histories, and peoples. Together they form the **Rootbound Covenant**, an alliance older than written law, bound by reverence for the living land rather than conquest. Each grove maintains autonomy while honoring the ancient pact that ties them together in times of crisis, celebration, or transformation.

Althamira



Theme/Vibe:

Shining, noble nation of scholars, knights, and diplomats. Ancient and well-established, exemplifying divine grace through prayer and sacred magic. A powerful bastion standing guard against the horrors that lurk in the **Badlands** beyond the **Sunmaker Mountains**, functioning as both a protector and beacon of civilization.

Parallels/Inspiration:

- Gondor (*Lord of the Rings*)
- Rivendell (*Lord of the Rings*)
- Gondolin (*Lord of the Rings*)

Government:

Theocratic Matriarchy. The nation is ruled by the **Daughters of War**, an elite order of knights, paladins, and clerics devoted to the eight good cardinal goddesses. The **Head Priestess of Sentium** (Goddess of Knowledge) serves as supreme leader, while champions representing each of the seven virtuous septuplets hold key governmental positions.

Description:

Althamira stands as a holy bastion of civilization. This ancient theocracy venerates eight goddesses: **Sentium**, the Goddess of Knowledge who guides the nation's spiritual governance, and her seven divine sisters: the virtuous septuplets embodying the heavenly virtues of Diligence, Chastity, Patience, Charity, Humility, Temperance, and Kindness.

The **Daughters of War**, an order of elite knights and clerics, govern Althamira through divine mandate. These chosen champions occupy positions of state, serving as administrators and exemplars of their goddesses' domains. The nation thrives on prayer rather than arcane study, drawing power directly from the divine.

Beyond the gleaming cities lies Althamira's sacred duty: standing watch as an eternal sentinel against the darkness beyond the **Sunmaker Mountains**.

Rian Ceil



Theme/Vibe:

Bureaucrats, taxers, and meticulous administrators. A labyrinth of red tape, regulations, and record-keeping. Neutral ground where disputes are settled with ledgers rather than swords, and where every transaction leaves a paper trail.

Parallels/Inspiration:

- The Azish Empire (*Stormlight Archives*)
- Feruchemists (*Mistborn* - stored knowledge and records)
- Switzerland (neutrality, banking, diplomatic mediation)

Government:

Bureaucratic Meritocracy. Governed by the **Grand Exchequer** and a council of officials who earn their positions through rigorous examinations in law, administration, and accounting. Rank within the government mirrors the physical tiers of the city itself, with advancement determined solely by demonstrated competence.

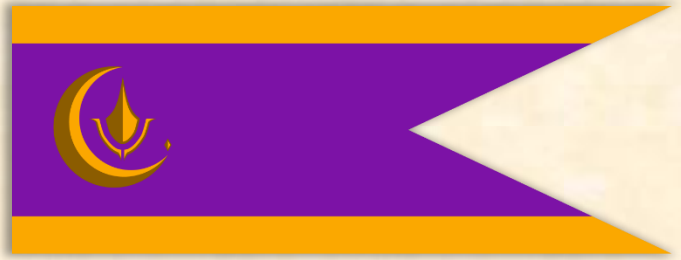
Description:

Rian Ceil rises as a single and massive tiered city-state. The architectural marvels of the city's fortifications serve more as symbol of its stability rather than a defensive necessity. Here, power flows not from divine mandate or ancient bloodlines, but from mastery of regulation, taxation, and trade law.

The city-state mints most of the world's currency and maintains immaculate records trusted across nations. Rian Ceil's ambassadors and dignitaries occupy high offices throughout Vedalon as advisors, notaries, and mediators, prized for their absolute neutrality. When kingdoms clash, they turn to Rian Ceil's experts to broker terms and witness oaths.

Beneath the endless bureaucracy thrives a bustling economy. Laborers, merchants, and craftspeople fill the lower tiers, facilitating the large volume of trade that passes through the city's gates. Deep within its vaults lie international treasuries where the world's elite store wealth, heirlooms, and secrets under layers of law and iron.

Vauclair



Theme/Vibe:

Peaceful, moonlit land of waving meadows and endless flowers. Fertile farmlands yield bountiful harvests while artisans craft world-renowned silks, jewelry, and magical gemwork. Beneath the surface beauty lies a well-kept secret that begs a moral question: what matters more, the nature of a ruler or the love of their people?

Parallels/Inspiration:

- Rivendell (*Lord of the Rings* - elven architecture)
- Regis (*Witcher 3* - benevolent vampire resisting his nature)
- Paarthurnax (*Skyrim* - "What is better? To be born good or to overcome your evil nature through great effort?")

Government:

Hereditary Monarchy. Ruled by an ancient bloodline of pale, long-lived nobles who appear as "elves" to their subjects. In truth, they are benevolent vampires sustained not by blood, but through prayer and divine magic granted by **Chastity**, Goddess of the Moon. Their true nature remains unknown to their people and the world at large.

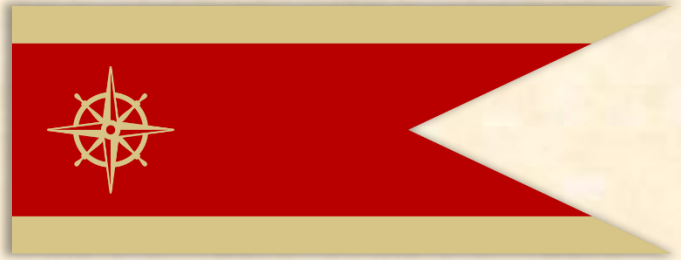
Description:

Vauclair blooms under moonlight. It is a land of fertile fields and artistic mastery, where its meadows produce flowers for rare dyes and its workshops craft silks, enchanted gems, and theatrical wonders sought across Vedalon. The nation exports both agricultural and luxury goods, earning its prosperity through craftsmanship and trade.

The ruling family has governed for centuries, beloved by their people for their wisdom, fairness, and devotion to the Goddess of the Moon. None suspect the truth: they are vampires who have sworn an eternal fast from blood. Through prayer, sacrifice, and divine grace, **Chastity** sustains them, allowing these ancient beings to guide their nation without succumbing to their darker nature.

They are old beyond measure and wise from centuries of rule, though not physically formidable. Their strength lies in the devotion and love of their people. Vauclair stands as living proof that redemption can be chosen, maintained, and made beautiful.

Davenport



Theme/Vibe:

Seafaring crossroads where morality bends with the tide. A chaotic, trade-heavy port city renowned for naval prowess and mercantile power. Officially neutral, unofficially corrupt. The line between merchant and smuggler blurs in the waters of the **Edrenian Sea**.

Parallels/Inspiration:

- Sabaody Archipelago (*One Piece* - major stopover for all travelers)
- Tortuga (pirate haven)
- Venice (maritime trade empire, thalassocracy)
- *Baldur's Gate* Lower City

Government:

Maritime Oligarchy. Ruled by a syndicate of naval captains and shipping magnates called the **Captain's Moot**. Any ship with three or more verified trade routes earns its captain a vote. Major decisions are made at sea where naval law, sea trials, and ship-to-ship votes determine policy. A façade of guilds and regulations conceals a foundation built on coin, compromise, and blackmail.

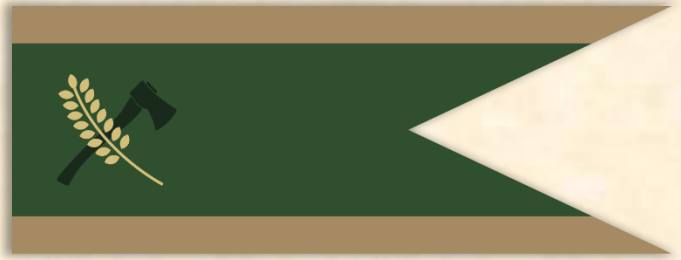
Description:

Davenport's strategic location and naval capability make it a vital stop on global trade routes, where goods of every legality flow through its docks. The city's reputation for exceptional ships and captains makes it indispensable to merchants and diplomats alike, though few trust it completely.

The **Captain's Moot** governs through a system combining pirate-code tradition with logistical power. Captains who control verified trade routes hold political sway, their votes cast during ship-conclaves held in open waters.

Beneath the surface, Davenport thrives as a gray-market capital. Smuggling operations run parallel to legitimate trade, and some of the city's most influential political figures are rumored to be pirate captains operating under pseudonyms. The nation-state's official neutrality in global politics covers a web of corruption where loyalty is bought.

Ornstead



Theme/Vibe:

Rustic, humble, and self-reliant. Small logging and hunting settlements where everyone knows your name. Blue-collar communities living fulfilling lives off the land. Grounded and unpretentious, defined and known by the people's hard work, craftsmanship, and quiet hospitality.

Parallels/Inspiration:

- The Shire (*Lord of the Rings*)
- White Orchard (*Witcher 3*)

Government:

Protectorate of Althamira. Local governance is the responsibility of the **Council of Village Headmen**, representatives from each settlement who convene in the main township to coordinate trade and resolve disputes. Althamira stations a **Warden** to oversee defense and handle foreign affairs, while villages retain autonomy over daily matters.

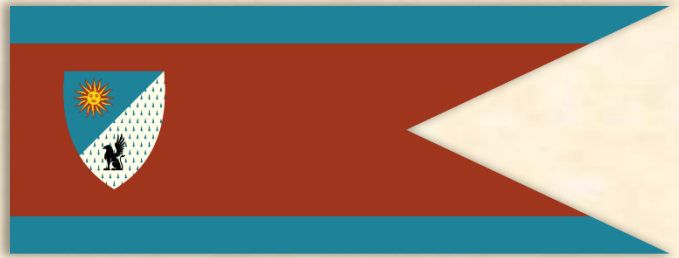
Description:

Ornstead is a collection of hamlets and villages scattered across forested hills and fertile pastures. It is anchored by a single main township that serves as an administrative and trade hub. This is a land of loggers, hunters, and farmers whose labor feeds surrounding nations.

The people of Ornstead live simply but well, their lives enriched by the demands of honest work. Lumber from their forests, crops from their fields, and livestock from their pastures supply much of Vedalon's nations. What they lack in scholars and soldiers, they make up for in resilience and community.

Under Althamira's protection, Ornstead enjoys security without surrendering its sovereignty. The stationed **Warden** handles threats from beyond while the **Council of Village Headmen** manages local affairs. Here, prosperity is measured in full barns, strong timber, and neighbors who help raise each other's homes.

Maelon Kingdom



Theme/Vibe:

Classic feudal monarchy. A proud nation with a long list of triumphs and trials. Iconic for their legendary griffin riders, symbolizing strength and majesty. Diverse and welcoming, a cultural melting pot where people from across Vedalon build lives together.

Parallels/Inspiration:

- Minas Tirith (*Lord of the Rings*)
- Velen/Novigrad (*Witcher 3* - has its good and bad, people getting by)
- The North (*Game of Thrones*)

Government:

Feudal Monarchy ruled by the Maelon family. Dukes, counts, and barons oversee regional administration across the kingdom's territories. Local guards maintain peacekeeping with minimal centralized enforcement. Common citizens petition the various guilds for aid, from the Mercantile Guild for trade escorts to Adventurers' Guilds for protection and problem-solving.

Description:

The Maelon Kingdom covers diverse terrain, from rolling plains to towering mountains to bustling coastal and riverside towns. It stands as one of Vedalon's larger nations, defined by the griffin riders who serve as both national symbol and practical service.

The capital city rises from a mountainside, its architecture incorporating natural alcoves where griffins nest. These majestic creatures and their riders are also known for providing air travel across nations at a premium.

The Maelon family rules with generally good intentions, though the usual cast of ambitious courtiers complicate governance. The kingdom maintains a strong standing army and values honor in service. What truly distinguishes Maelon, however, is its people. The kingdom hosts Vedalon's largest mixed diaspora, where Maelonians live alongside migrants from neighboring nations, creating a rich blend of cultures, trades, and traditions.